

# Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

## Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

## Customer Details

Name: Ms Tazkera Sadeq

Address: 16 Brasted Close Sutton SM2 5BE

## Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Comment - Planning Application DM2025/01591

I am a local resident and a parent of multiple children at Avenue Primary School. I support this application for the following reasons:

1. Since 2021, Friday congregational prayers organised by BASMA have taken place at a nearby church hall without noticeable problems with noise, traffic, parking or safety. That location is closer to Avenue Primary School's main entrance, the busy Belmont High Street and a more congested traffic area, with less parking available. The proposed site is further away from these constraints and includes its own on-site parking provision which is an improvement.

2. There is no congregational prayer during the school morning peak around 8:30am, presenting no overlap at that busy morning time (including school and commuter traffic). Accordingly, no material change to traffic conditions would arise at that time. The existing Friday prayer timing already coincides with school hours at the current location and has not created issues, and bus services continue to operate normally.

3. As a parent using the school regularly, I have been able to find parking when needed, and I frequently observe parking wardens managing the area. Many pupils also travel by bus, and services run reliably, indicating that traffic conditions remain manageable in practice.

4. The proposed place of worship and community facility is unlikely to generate concentrated or constant daily activity, as most people are at work during weekdays. The main weekly gathering is

Friday congregational prayer, which has been established locally and operated in an orderly and well-managed manner since 2021.

5. Friday prayers have been held at the local church since 2021 and managed successfully by BASMA over several years without disturbance. Attendance is typically staggered across multiple sittings and more than one congregation, naturally spreading arrival and departure times and avoiding concentrated peaks.

6. BASMA has been part of the local community for several years and has worked positively with local residents, the church and with the knowledge of the Council. As an established local organisation experienced in managing activities responsibly, it is well placed to operate and manage its own, much-needed, premises to serve the growing needs of local residents. BASMA maintains clear, organised communication with its users and activities are conducted in a structured, well-managed and respectful manner.

7. There is currently no nearby dedicated facility of this kind, and a once-weekly temporary arrangement does not meet the needs of the growing community. A permanent, fit-for-purpose space would better support women, families and older residents, particularly women who benefit from accessible and appropriate community provision.

8. Community and social infrastructure that supports inclusion, wellbeing and local cohesion is recognised within local and London planning policy, and this proposal contributes positively in that context.

9. The facility will primarily serve the same local community already using BASMA's services, many of whom attend on foot, including myself and my family. This represents continuity rather than a new influx of visitors. The proposed site, with more appropriate space and on-site parking, is likely to improve existing arrangements rather than create additional noise or traffic pressure.

10. The proposal also makes constructive use of a disused site that formerly operated as a 24-hour ambulance station, a use which historically generated traffic and activity at all hours.

11. Based on what has already been operating locally, for local residents, for several years without issue, I support the provision of this much-needed community facility in this location. It will provide improved and more appropriate provision to meet the needs of the local community.

Taking all of the above into account, the proposal builds on a well-established and responsibly managed local community presence and represents a proportionate and positive addition to local community infrastructure. I therefore support this application.